



Moto's up-grade

After Samsung ad mocking iPhones, Motorola ad takes a dig at the former and the Galaxy.
<http://dgit.in/UpUpgrade>



Any FB photo could be deleted

A researcher found a vulnerability that allowed the deletion of any photo from Facebook.
<http://dgit.in/FbPhotoFlaw>

the backend for further processing. While speech recognition is by itself simple, the main hurdle is deriving the context of the speech in a sentence. So, while a user can say "four miles" to indicate 4 miles (between two locations say) it is also phonetically similar to "for Miles" as in for the singer Miles Davis. This is where differentiating the context is important, and Alexa achieves this by using a set of 'utterances' – that is, training data for its already pre-trained machine learning model. The voice user interface in Alexa can be built on the developer.amazon.com portal.

PROGRAMMING LOGIC

This is essentially the 'backend' of the application which handles the intent supplied by the voice user interface. In the simplest sense, it is an https URL that is called when an action is recognized by the device. Amazon recommends the use of its 'Lambda service' to setup a serverless backend for Alexa as it allows for easy optimization using its existing ecosystem. It also allows audio streaming, text to speech or SSML (Simple Speech Markup Language - HTML like syntax for text-to-speech) from the backend service.

We will look at this in greater detail at a later stage.

UTTERANCES

An utterance is a sample of a voice command that the user needs to say in order for Alexa to map it to a specific skill and intent.

An utterance consists of the wake word (usually 'Alexa'), the starting phase ('ask', 'tell' etc), the skill invocation name ('Ola', 'Zomato') and the utterance ('book me a cab to work') to launch the specific intent for the skill.

DESIGNING THE VOICE USER INTERFACE

We will first design the Voice User Interface for our skill on developer.amazon.com. To do this, login to your developer

account on Amazon and navigate to the **Alexa** tab, then click on **Create a New Skill**.

Once the skills homescreen is open, click on the **Add a new Skill** button to open a wizard. As of today, there are four types of skills that you can create for the Alexa service, these are:

- Custom Interaction Model
- Smart Home Skill
- Flash Briefing Skill
- Video Skill

For now, let us focus on the simple Custom Interaction Model API.

Select a language (for example, **English, India**), write the name of the Skill, eg: Egg recipe Skill and then add the Invocation name for your Skill (let's call it Egginator).



Creating a new Alexa skill

The invocation name for your skill is crucial as it is used to call on your skill by Alexa. Typically it should be at most 2-3 words long, easy to pronounce and not use an already reserved word, so as not to conflict with other skills.

There are also a couple of global variables, like if you would need to have a long audio response (>90 sec) for your skill or if you need to use the video/render template modules in it.

Once this is done, click next to move to the skill builder page which has a Skill builder button, clicking on it opens another wizard that allows easy creation of intents (the defaults for Help, Stop and Cancel intents are already provided).

To create a custom intent, simply provide a name for it, and add a set of sample utterances that trigger it.

*CODING MATTERS



*Google's Fuchsia OS forks Swift

The Google team developing the mysterious Fuchsia OS forked Apple's Swift language. Now it seems that the fork was to add code that supported Fuchsia - but why?
<http://dgit.in/GFuchsia>



*Limited time free Windows 10 VM

Microsoft is hoping to tempt developers to create UWP apps with a free virtual machine that comes preloaded with Windows 10 Enterprise and Visual Studio 2017. Unfortunately, the VM expires on January 15.
<http://dgit.in/Win10VM>



*AWS Amplify opens cloud services for JavaScript

Amazon has released an open source library for interacting with cloud services that use JavaScript applications.
<http://dgit.in/AWSamp>